

Jeremiah 31 - 33

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Messianic Connections (WEB)

Tonight we reach the summit of the book. Everything Jeremiah has carried - the belt, the drought, the yoke, the broken jar - has been clearing ground for these three chapters.

A love called everlasting, and a God who says He drew us before we ever turned.

A covenant that will not be written on stone but on the inside of a person.

A prophet in a prison cell buying real estate in a country that is about to be destroyed.

Jeremiah 31 gathers the scattered, dries the eyes of Rachel, retires an old proverb about sour grapes, and then announces a new covenant that the New Testament will quote at greater length than any other Old Testament passage.

Jeremiah 32 puts the prophet under arrest during the siege and tells him to buy a field - and then lets him admit to Yahweh's face that the command makes no sense.

Jeremiah 33 opens with an invitation that has kept people praying for twenty-six centuries: call to me, and I will answer you, and will show you great and difficult things which you don't know.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 31 - Everlasting Love and the New Covenant

Key Notes

- The chapter opens with the covenant formula stretched to its widest reach - not Judah only, but “all the families of Israel,” including the northern tribes gone for a century (Jeremiah 31:1).
- “I have loved you with an everlasting love. Therefore I have drawn you with loving kindness.” The drawing is the consequence of the loving, not its reward (Jeremiah 31:3).
- The return is pictured as a party, not a procession - tambourines, dancing, vineyards planted on the mountains of Samaria by people who will live to eat the fruit (Jeremiah 31:4-5).
- The gathered company is deliberately unimpressive: the blind, the lame, the pregnant, the woman in labor. Nobody is left behind for slowing the column down (Jeremiah 31:8).
- “He who scattered Israel will gather him.” The same hand does both, which is why the exile was never a sign that He had lost track of them (Jeremiah 31:10).
- Rachel is heard weeping in Ramah - the staging town for deportation - and is told to stop, because “there is hope for your latter end” (Jeremiah 31:15-17).
- Ephraim’s repentance is quoted back with a prayer inside it: “Turn me, and I will be turned.” Even the turning is asked for as a gift (Jeremiah 31:18).
- Yahweh’s answer is the most emotional line in the book: “my heart yearns for him. I will surely have mercy on him.” The Hebrew is visceral, the language of a parent’s insides (Jeremiah 31:20).
- The four demolition verbs of chapter 1 are answered at last - He watched to pluck up and break down; now He watches to build and to plant (Jeremiah 31:28).
- A proverb is formally retired. No more “the fathers have eaten sour grapes” - each person will die for his own iniquity, and the excuse of inherited fate goes with it (Jeremiah 31:29-30).
- Then the new covenant: not like the one they broke, but Torah written on the inward parts, a knowledge of Yahweh needing no intermediary, and sin remembered no more (Jeremiah 31:31-34).
- The guarantee is cosmological. Israel’s continuance is pinned to the fixed order of sun, moon, and sea - if those fail, then and only then does the promise fail (Jeremiah 31:35-37).
- The chapter ends by taking the valley of dead bodies and ashes - the Hinnom of chapter 19 - and declaring it holy to Yahweh, never to be plucked up again (Jeremiah 31:38-40).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Loved First, Drawn After	Jeremiah 31:3 • Deuteronomy 7:7-8 • Hosea 11:4
Gathered by the One Who Scattered	Jeremiah 31:10 • Ezekiel 34:12 • Isaiah 40:11
Rachel Weeping in Ramah	Jeremiah 31:15 • Genesis 35:19 • 1 Samuel 10:2

Topic	References
"Turn Me, and I Will Be Turned"	Jeremiah 31:18 • Lamentations 5:21 • Psalm 80:3
A Father's Yearning Heart	Jeremiah 31:20 • Hosea 11:8 • Isaiah 49:15
The Sour-Grapes Proverb Retired	Jeremiah 31:29-30 • Ezekiel 18:2-4 • Deuteronomy 24:16
The Covenant They Broke	Jeremiah 31:32 • Exodus 24:7-8 • Exodus 19:5-6
Fixed as Sun, Moon, and Sea	Jeremiah 31:35-36 • Genesis 8:22 • Psalm 89:36-37

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
An Everlasting Love Nothing Can Sever	Jeremiah 31:3 • Romans 8:38-39 • John 13:1
One Flock Gathered From the Scattered	Jeremiah 31:10 • Ezekiel 34:12 • John 11:52
Ransomed From a Hand Stronger Than Ours	Jeremiah 31:11 • Titus 2:14 • 1 Peter 1:18-19
Rachel's Tears and Bethlehem	Jeremiah 31:15 • Matthew 2:16-18 • Revelation 21:4
The New Covenant in His Blood	Jeremiah 31:31 • Luke 22:20 • Hebrews 9:15
Torah Written on Hearts of Flesh	Jeremiah 31:33 • 2 Corinthians 3:3 • Ezekiel 36:26-27
Their Sins Remembered No More	Jeremiah 31:34 • Hebrews 10:16-17 • 1 John 1:9

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 31 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - verse-by-verse treatment of the restoration promises and the new covenant oracle
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 31](#) - the new covenant read as Torah internalized rather than Torah abolished
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 31](#) - exposition of verses 31-34 and how Hebrews 8 handles them

Jeremiah 31 - Opening Intro

Start with verse 3, because everything else in this chapter runs downhill from it. "I have loved you with an everlasting love. Therefore I have drawn you with loving kindness." Read the logic carefully. He did not draw them and then decide to love them. The love came first, and the drawing is what the love does.

That order matters enormously by the time you reach verse 18, where Ephraim prays the strangest and most honest prayer in the book: "Turn me, and I will be turned." He does not say I will turn. He asks to

be turned. He has apparently tried, and found that repentance is something he needs done to him before he can do it.

And Yahweh's reply in verse 20 is worth reading aloud. The Hebrew word behind "my heart yearns" refers to the inward parts - the churn in your gut when you see someone you love in trouble. It is the same root behind the word for a mother's womb. This is not a formal pardon issued from a bench. This is a father who cannot help himself.

Then comes verse 31, and the phrase that gives the second half of the Bible its name. A new covenant - berit hadashah, which the Greek renders kaine diatheke. Notice what is new about it and what is not. The content is not replaced: "I will put my law in their inward parts." It is the same Torah. What changes is the location. It moves from tablets to tissue, from an external standard to an internal instinct.

And the last clause is the one that makes it good news rather than merely a better system: "I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more." Hebrews quotes these four verses twice, at greater length than any other Old Testament passage in the New Testament, and both times the writer lands on that line.

Before we read, hold the very last verse next to chapter 19. That valley of dead bodies and ashes is Hinnom - the place where children were burned, the place Yahweh renamed the Valley of Slaughter. Here He says it will be holy to Yahweh, and never plucked up again. If He will do that with that valley, there is nothing in your history He cannot consecrate.

Jeremiah 31:1-40 (WEB)

1 "At that time," says Yahweh, "I will be the God of all the families of Israel, and they will be my people."

2 Yahweh says, "The people who survive the sword found favor in the wilderness; even Israel, when I went to cause him to rest."

3 Yahweh appeared of old to me, saying, "Yes, I have loved you with an everlasting love. Therefore I have drawn you with loving kindness."^{1,2}

4 I will build you again, and you will be built, O virgin of Israel. You will again be adorned with your tambourines, and will go out in the dances of those who make merry.

5 Again you will plant vineyards on the mountains of Samaria. The planters will plant, and will enjoy its fruit.

6 For there will be a day that the watchmen on the hills of Ephraim cry, 'Arise, and let us go up to Zion to Yahweh our God.'"

¹ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 7:7-8](#) • [Hosea 11:4](#) - chosen not for size or merit but because He loved them, drawn with cords of a man

² **Messianic Connection:** [Romans 8:38-39](#) • [John 13:1](#) - nothing able to separate us from the love of God, having loved His own to the end

7 For Yahweh says, “Sing with gladness for Jacob, and shout for the chief of the nations. Publish, praise, and say, ‘Yahweh, save your people, the remnant of Israel!’

8 Behold, I will bring them from the north country, and gather them from the uttermost parts of the earth, along with the blind and the lame, the woman with child and her who travails with child together. They will return as a great company.

9 They will come with weeping. I will lead them with petitions. I will cause them to walk by rivers of waters, in a straight way in which they won’t stumble; for I am a father to Israel. Ephraim is my firstborn.

10 “Hear Yahweh’s word, you nations, and declare it in the distant islands. Say, ‘He who scattered Israel will gather him, and keep him, as a shepherd does his flock.’³

11 For Yahweh has ransomed Jacob, and redeemed him from the hand of him who was stronger than he.⁴

12 They will come and sing in the height of Zion, and will flow to the goodness of Yahweh, to the grain, to the new wine, to the oil, and to the young of the flock and of the herd. Their soul will be as a watered garden. They will not sorrow any more at all.

13 Then the virgin will rejoice in the dance; the young men and the old together; for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow.

14 I will satiate the soul of the priests with fatness, and my people will be satisfied with my goodness,” says Yahweh.

15 Yahweh says: “A voice is heard in Ramah, lamentation and bitter weeping, Rachel weeping for her children. She refuses to be comforted for her children, because they are no more.”⁵

16 Yahweh says: “Refrain your voice from weeping, and your eyes from tears; for your work will be rewarded,” says Yahweh. “They will come again from the land of the enemy.

17 There is hope for your latter end,” says Yahweh. “Your children will come again to their own territory.

18 “I have surely heard Ephraim grieving thus, ‘You have chastised me, and I was chastised, as an untrained calf. Turn me, and I will be turned; for you are Yahweh my God.’⁶

19 Surely after that I was turned. I repented. After that I was instructed. I struck my thigh. I was ashamed, yes, even confounded, because I bore the reproach of my youth.’

³ **Messianic Connection:** [Ezekiel 34:12](#) • [John 11:52](#) - the shepherd seeking out scattered sheep, gathering into one the children of God

⁴ **Messianic Connection:** [Titus 2:14](#) • [1 Peter 1:18-19](#) - redeemed not with silver or gold but with the precious blood of a lamb without blemish

⁵ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 2:16-18](#) • [Revelation 21:4](#) - Rachel’s weeping heard again at Bethlehem, and every tear finally wiped away

⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Lamentations 5:21](#) • [Psalm 80:3](#) - turn us to yourself and we shall be turned - repentance asked for as a gift, not achieved

20 Is Ephraim my dear son? Is he a darling child? For as often as I speak against him, I still earnestly remember him. therefore my heart yearns for him. I will surely have mercy on him," says Yahweh.⁷

21 "Set up road signs. Make guideposts. Set your heart toward the highway, even the way by which you went. Turn again, virgin of Israel. Turn again to these your cities.

22 How long will you go here and there, you backsliding daughter? For Yahweh has created a new thing in the earth: a woman will encompass a man."

23 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: "Yet again they will use this speech in the land of Judah and in its cities, when I reverse their captivity: 'Yahweh bless you, habitation of righteousness, mountain of holiness.'

24 Judah and all its cities will dwell therein together, the farmers, and those who go about with flocks.

25 For I have satiated the weary soul, and I have replenished every sorrowful soul."

26 On this I awakened, and saw; and my sleep was sweet to me.

27 "Behold, the days come," says Yahweh, "that I will sow the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the seed of man and with the seed of animal.

28 It will happen that, like as I have watched over them to pluck up and to break down and to overthrow and to destroy and to afflict, so will I watch over them to build and to plant," says Yahweh.

29 "In those days they will say no more, "'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge.'⁸

30 But everyone will die for his own iniquity. Every man who eats the sour grapes, his teeth will be set on edge.

31 "Behold, the days come," says Yahweh, "that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah:^{9,10}

32 not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which covenant of mine they broke, although I was a husband to them," says Yahweh.

⁷ **Cross-Reference:** [Hosea 11:8](#) • [Isaiah 49:15](#) - a heart turned over within Him, and a love more certain than a nursing mother's

⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Ezekiel 18:2-4](#) • [Deuteronomy 24:16](#) - the same proverb answered by Ezekiel, and the Torah's rule that each dies for his own sin

⁹ **Cross-Reference:** [Exodus 24:7-8](#) • [Exodus 19:5-6](#) - the Sinai covenant sealed in blood, and the terms this new one is measured against

¹⁰ **Messianic Connection:** [Luke 22:20](#) • [Hebrews 9:15](#) - this cup is the new covenant in my blood, and the Mediator of a better one

33 “But this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days,” says Yahweh: I will put my law in their inward parts, and I will write it in their heart. I will be their God, and they shall be my people.^{[11](#)}

34 They will no longer each teach his neighbor, and every man teach his brother, saying, ‘Know Yahweh;’ for they will all know me, from their least to their greatest,” says Yahweh: “for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.”^{[12](#)}

35 Yahweh, who gives the sun for a light by day, and the ordinances of the moon and of the stars for a light by night, who stirs up the sea, so that its waves roar; Yahweh of Armies is his name, says:

36 “If these ordinances depart from before me,” says Yahweh, “then the offspring of Israel also will cease from being a nation before me forever.”

37 Yahweh says: “If heaven above can be measured, and the foundations of the earth searched out beneath, then I will also cast off all the offspring of Israel for all that they have done,” says Yahweh.

38 “Behold, the days come,” says Yahweh, “that the city will be built to Yahweh from the tower of Hananel to the gate of the corner.

39 The measuring line will go out further straight onward to the hill Gareb, and will turn toward Goah.

40 The whole valley of the dead bodies and of the ashes, and all the fields to the brook Kidron, to the corner of the horse gate toward the east, will be holy to Yahweh. It will not be plucked up or thrown down any more forever.”

^{[11](#)} **Messianic Connection:** [2 Corinthians 3:3](#) • [Ezekiel 36:26-27](#) - written not on tablets of stone but on tablets of human hearts, by the Spirit given within

^{[12](#)} **Messianic Connection:** [Hebrews 10:16-17](#) • [1 John 1:9](#) - their sins and lawless deeds remembered no more, and cleansing promised to the one who confesses

CHAPTER 32 - The Field Bought Under Siege

Key Notes

- The date is the tenth year of Zedekiah, eighteenth of Nebuchadnezzar - roughly a year before the walls fall. The siege is already underway (Jeremiah 32:1-2).
- Jeremiah is under arrest in the court of the guard, jailed by his own king for saying the city would be taken - which it is about to be (Jeremiah 32:2-5).
- Yahweh tells him in advance that his cousin Hanamel will show up wanting to sell a field, and when Hanamel walks in, Jeremiah says simply, "Then I knew that this was Yahweh's word" (Jeremiah 32:6-8).
- The transaction is recorded in almost comic legal detail: seventeen shekels weighed out, the deed signed and sealed, an open copy and a sealed copy, witnesses called, everything filed (Jeremiah 32:9-12).
- The deeds go into an earthen jar "that they may last many days" - the same kind of jar in which the Dead Sea Scrolls would survive six centuries in the Judean desert (Jeremiah 32:14).
- The point is stated in one sentence: "Houses and fields and vineyards will yet again be bought in this land." The purchase is a prophecy performed with money (Jeremiah 32:15).
- Then, remarkably, Jeremiah prays - and his prayer begins with confident theology and ends in open confusion. "There is nothing too hard for you" is verse 17 (Jeremiah 32:16-23).
- By verse 25 the confidence has run out: "You have said to me, Buy the field... whereas the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans." He obeyed first and questioned after (Jeremiah 32:24-25).
- Yahweh answers by turning Jeremiah's own sentence into a question: "Is there anything too hard for me?" The prophet's theology is handed back to him as an examination (Jeremiah 32:27).
- The indictment that follows is comprehensive - kings, princes, priests, prophets, and people - and returns to the valley of Hinnom, and to the phrase "it didn't even come into my mind" (Jeremiah 32:28-35).
- And then "Now therefore" - and the whole direction reverses. Gathered, brought back, dwelling safely, one heart and one way, an everlasting covenant, His fear put inside them (Jeremiah 32:36-40).
- The most startling promise is verse 41: "I will rejoice over them to do them good... with my whole heart and with my whole soul." God describes Himself as wholehearted about us (Jeremiah 32:41-44).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Right of Redemption	Jeremiah 32:7 • Leviticus 25:25 • Ruth 4:3-6
Silver Weighed Out in a Purchase	Jeremiah 32:9 • Genesis 23:16 • Zechariah 11:12-13

Topic	References
Documents Preserved for a Later Day	Jeremiah 32:14 • Isaiah 30:8 • Habakkuk 2:2-3
“Nothing Too Hard for You”	Jeremiah 32:17 • Genesis 18:14 • Psalm 135:6
The God of All Flesh	Jeremiah 32:27 • Numbers 16:22 • Job 42:2
Hinnom, and What Never Entered His Mind	Jeremiah 32:35 • Jeremiah 7:31 • Leviticus 18:21
One Heart and One Way	Jeremiah 32:39 • Ezekiel 11:19-20 • Deuteronomy 30:6
Rejoicing Over Them to Do Them Good	Jeremiah 32:41 • Zephaniah 3:17 • Deuteronomy 30:9

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
A Kinsman Who Redeems the Forfeited	Jeremiah 32:7 • Ephesians 1:13-14 • Romans 8:23
Nothing Impossible With God	Jeremiah 32:17 • Luke 1:37 • Matthew 19:26
A Deed Held Against the Day of Redemption	Jeremiah 32:14 • Ephesians 4:30 • Revelation 5:1-5
An Everlasting Covenant He Will Not Abandon	Jeremiah 32:40 • Hebrews 13:20 • John 10:28-29
His Fear Placed Within Us	Jeremiah 32:40 • Philippians 2:13 • Hebrews 13:21
Fields Bought Again in a Ruined Land	Jeremiah 32:44 • Amos 9:14 • Ezekiel 36:33-35

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 32 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the field at Anathoth, the sealed and open deeds, and Jeremiah’s prayer of confusion
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 32](#) - the redemption law behind the purchase and the everlasting covenant of verses 37-41
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 32](#) - exposition of obedience preceding understanding in the Anathoth transaction

Jeremiah 32 - Opening Intro

Consider the position Jeremiah is in when this chapter opens. He is in custody. The Babylonian army is camped outside the walls. The land around Anathoth - three miles north of Jerusalem - is almost certainly already occupied. And his cousin walks into the prison yard with a real estate offer.

Every instinct says no. The property is worthless. The seller knows it is worthless, which is precisely why he is selling. And the buyer is a man who has spent forty years announcing that this exact catastrophe was coming, so nobody could accuse Jeremiah of not seeing it clearly.

He buys it anyway. Seventeen shekels, weighed out on a balance, in a besieged city, for a field he will never plow.

And the legal detail in verses 9 through 12 is not padding. Two copies - one sealed for the archive, one open for inspection - witnesses, signatures, the whole apparatus. Jeremiah is not making a gesture. He is creating a document that will still be valid in seventy years, and he puts it in a clay jar so it will survive, which is exactly how the Dead Sea Scrolls came down to us.

Here is what makes this chapter honest rather than merely inspiring: he obeys completely, and then he prays a prayer that falls apart. Verse 17 is magnificent - "there is nothing too hard for you." Verse 25 is a man with his hands open, saying the equivalent of: I did what you said, and I do not understand it. The siege ramps are up. Why am I buying dirt?

And Yahweh's answer is to quote him back to himself. "Is there anything too hard for me?" He does not explain the field. He asks whether Jeremiah believed what he just said.

Before we read, notice where the chapter ends up. Not with the deed, but with verse 41: "I will rejoice over them to do them good... with my whole heart and with my whole soul." The same God who spent thirty chapters on judgment describes His intention toward His people as wholehearted delight. Both are true, and only one of them is the last word.

Jeremiah 32:1-44 (WEB)

1 The word that came to Jeremiah from Yahweh in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar.

2 Now at that time the king of Babylon's army was besieging Jerusalem. Jeremiah the prophet was shut up in the court of the guard, which was in the king of Judah's house.

3 For Zedekiah king of Judah had shut him up, saying, "Why do you prophesy, and say, 'Yahweh says, "Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will take it;

4 and Zedekiah king of Judah won't escape out of the hand of the Chaldeans, but will surely be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon, and will speak with him mouth to mouth, and his eyes will see his eyes;

5 and he will bring Zedekiah to Babylon, and he will be there until I visit him," says Yahweh: "though you fight with the Chaldeans, you will not prosper?"'"

6 Jeremiah said, "Yahweh's word came to me, saying,

7 'Behold, Hanamel the son of Shallum your uncle will come to you, saying, "Buy my field that is in Anathoth; for the right of redemption is yours to buy it."'" ^{13,14}

8 "So Hanamel my uncle's son came to me in the court of the guard according to Yahweh's word, and said to me, 'Please buy my field that is in Anathoth, which is in the land of Benjamin; for the right of inheritance is yours, and the redemption is yours. Buy it for yourself.' "Then I knew that this was Yahweh's word.

9 I bought the field that was in Anathoth of Hanamel my uncle's son, and weighed him the money, even seventeen shekels of silver. ¹⁵

10 I signed the deed, sealed it, called witnesses, and weighed the money in the balances to him.

11 So I took the deed of the purchase, both that which was sealed, containing the terms and conditions, and that which was open;

12 and I delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the presence of Hanamel my uncle's son, and in the presence of the witnesses who subscribed the deed of the purchase, before all the Jews who sat in the court of the guard.

13 "I commanded Baruch before them, saying,

14 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: 'Take these deeds, this deed of the purchase which is sealed, and this deed which is open, and put them in an earthen vessel, that they may last many days.' ¹⁶

15 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: 'Houses and fields and vineyards will yet again be bought in this land.'

16 Now after I had delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of Neriah, I prayed to Yahweh, saying,

17 "Ah Lord Yahweh! Behold, you have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm. There is nothing too hard for you, ^{17,18}

18 who show loving kindness to thousands, and repay the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them; the great, the mighty God, Yahweh of Armies is his name;

¹³ **Cross-Reference:** [Leviticus 25:25](#) • [Ruth 4:3-6](#) - the kinsman's duty to redeem a relative's land so the inheritance stays in the family

¹⁴ **Messianic Connection:** [Ephesians 1:13-14](#) • [Romans 8:23](#) - the Spirit as a down payment guaranteeing an inheritance not yet taken possession of

¹⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Genesis 23:16](#) • [Zechariah 11:12-13](#) - silver weighed out in the presence of witnesses - the pattern of a binding purchase

¹⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Isaiah 30:8](#) • [Habakkuk 2:2-3](#) - the word written down and preserved because the vision is for an appointed time still ahead

¹⁷ **Cross-Reference:** [Genesis 18:14](#) • [Psalm 135:6](#) - is anything too hard for Yahweh? - and He does whatever pleases Him

¹⁸ **Messianic Connection:** [Luke 1:37](#) • [Matthew 19:26](#) - no word from God is void of power, and with God all things are possible

19 great in counsel, and mighty in work; whose eyes are open to all the ways of the sons of men, to give everyone according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings;

20 who performed signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, even to this day, both in Israel and among other men; and made yourself a name, as it is today;

21 and brought your people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs, with wonders, with a strong hand, with an outstretched arm, and with great terror;

22 and gave them this land, which you swore to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey.

23 They came in and possessed it, but they didn't obey your voice and didn't walk in your law. They have done nothing of all that you commanded them to do. Therefore you have caused all this evil to come upon them.

24 "Behold, siege ramps have come to the city to take it. The city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans who fight against it, because of the sword, of the famine, and of the pestilence. What you have spoken has happened. Behold, you see it.

25 You have said to me, Lord Yahweh, 'Buy the field for money, and call witnesses;' whereas the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans."

26 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, saying,

27 "Behold, I am Yahweh, the God of all flesh. Is there anything too hard for me?"¹⁹

28 Therefore Yahweh says: Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the Chaldeans, and into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will take it.

29 The Chaldeans, who fight against this city, will come and set this city on fire, and burn it with the houses on whose roofs they have offered incense to Baal, and poured out drink offerings to other gods, to provoke me to anger.

30 "For the children of Israel and the children of Judah have done only that which was evil in my sight from their youth; for the children of Israel have only provoked me to anger with the work of their hands, says Yahweh.

31 For this city has been to me a provocation of my anger and of my wrath from the day that they built it even to this day, so that I should remove it from before my face,

32 because of all the evil of the children of Israel and of the children of Judah, which they have done to provoke me to anger: they, their kings, their princes, their priests, their prophets, the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

¹⁹ Cross-Reference: [Numbers 16:22](#) • [Job 42:2](#) - the God of the spirits of all flesh, and the confession that no purpose of His can be withheld

33 They have turned their backs to me, and not their faces. Although I taught them, rising up early and teaching them, yet they have not listened to receive instruction.

34 But they set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to defile it.

35 They built the high places of Baal, which are in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to cause their sons and their daughters to pass through fire to Molech; which I didn't command them. It didn't even come into my mind, that they should do this abomination, to cause Judah to sin."²⁰

36 Now therefore Yahweh, the God of Israel, says concerning this city, about which you say, "It is given into the hand of the king of Babylon by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence:"

37 "Behold, I will gather them out of all the countries where I have driven them in my anger, and in my wrath, and in great indignation; and I will bring them again to this place. I will cause them to dwell safely.

38 Then they will be my people, and I will be their God.

39 I will give them one heart and one way, that they may fear me forever, for their good, and the good of their children after them."²¹

40 I will make an everlasting covenant with them, that I will not turn away from following them, to do them good. I will put my fear in their hearts, that they may not depart from me."²²

41 Yes, I will rejoice over them to do them good, and I will plant them in this land assuredly with my whole heart and with my whole soul."²³

42 For Yahweh says: "Just as I have brought all this great evil on this people, so will I bring on them all the good that I have promised them.

43 Fields will be bought in this land, about which you say, 'It is desolate, without man or animal. It is given into the hand of the Chaldeans.'

44 Men will buy fields for money, sign the deeds, seal them, and call witnesses, in the land of Benjamin, and in the places around Jerusalem, in the cities of Judah, in the cities of the hill country, in the cities of the lowland, and in the cities of the South; for I will cause their captivity to be reversed," says Yahweh."²⁴

²⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 7:31](#) • [Leviticus 18:21](#) - the Hinnom fires again, and the Torah command that made them unthinkable

²¹ **Cross-Reference:** [Ezekiel 11:19-20](#) • [Deuteronomy 30:6](#) - one heart given so they walk in His statutes, and a heart circumcised by Yahweh Himself

²² **Messianic Connection:** [Hebrews 13:20](#) • [John 10:28-29](#) - the blood of an everlasting covenant, and no one able to snatch them out of His hand

²³ **Cross-Reference:** [Zephaniah 3:17](#) • [Deuteronomy 30:9](#) - Yahweh rejoicing over His people with singing, delighting in them for good

²⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [Amos 9:14](#) • [Ezekiel 36:33-35](#) - ruined cities rebuilt and vineyards planted, the desolate land become like Eden

CHAPTER 33 - Call to Me, and I Will Answer

Key Notes

- The setting is unchanged - still the court of the guard, still under arrest. Verse 1 says the word came “the second time,” which means the encouragement of chapter 32 was not the end of it (Jeremiah 33:1).
- Yahweh introduces Himself by what He does rather than by what He is: the One who does it, who forms it, who establishes it (Jeremiah 33:2).
- “Call to me, and I will answer you, and will show you great and difficult things, which you don’t know.” The invitation is issued to a man in a cell, about a future he cannot see (Jeremiah 33:3).
- The city’s houses are being torn down for rubble to plug the breaches - and it will not work. The promise comes with the demolition still audible (Jeremiah 33:4-5).
- “I will bring it health and cure” answers the incurable wound of chapter 30 directly, and adds “abundance of peace and truth” (Jeremiah 33:6).
- Forgiveness is stated twice for emphasis - cleansed from all iniquity, pardoned for all iniquities - and it precedes the rebuilding rather than following it (Jeremiah 33:8).
- The purpose of the restoration is missional: this city becomes a name of joy before all the nations of the earth, who hear the good and tremble at it (Jeremiah 33:9).
- The silenced sounds of chapter 7 and chapter 25 come back one by one - joy, gladness, bridegroom, bride, and the thanksgiving refrain sung in Yahweh’s house (Jeremiah 33:10-11).
- The Branch oracle of chapter 23 returns, with one striking change: there the name Yahweh Our Righteousness belonged to Him; here it is given to the city (Jeremiah 33:15-16).
- Two guarantees are attached - a descendant of David on the throne, and Levites offering continually - and both are tied to the covenant of day and night (Jeremiah 33:17-22).
- The people are quoted saying the quiet thing out loud: “Has Yahweh cast off the two families which he chose?” And Yahweh answers by pointing at the sunrise (Jeremiah 33:23-26).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Call to Me, and I Will Answer	Jeremiah 33:3 • Psalm 91:15 • Isaiah 65:24
Health and Cure for an Incurable Wound	Jeremiah 33:6 • Jeremiah 30:17 • Isaiah 57:18-19
Cleansed and Pardoned Before Rebuilt	Jeremiah 33:8 • Micah 7:18-19 • Psalm 51:2
The Silenced Sounds Restored	Jeremiah 33:11 • Jeremiah 7:34 • Jeremiah 25:10
“His Loving Kindness Endures Forever”	Jeremiah 33:11 • Psalm 136:1 • 2 Chronicles 5:13
The Davidic Covenant	Jeremiah 33:17 • 2 Samuel 7:12-16 • Psalm 89:3-4

Topic	References
A Covenant of Everlasting Priesthood	Jeremiah 33:18 • Numbers 25:12-13 • Malachi 3:3
Fixed as Day and Night	Jeremiah 33:20 • Genesis 8:22 • Psalm 89:36-37

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
Great and Difficult Things Shown to Us	Jeremiah 33:3 • John 15:7 • Ephesians 3:20
The Voice of the Bridegroom Heard Again	Jeremiah 33:11 • John 3:29 • Revelation 19:7
The Branch of Righteousness Grown Up to David	Jeremiah 33:15 • Jeremiah 23:5-6 • Isaiah 4:2
Yahweh Our Righteousness Given to His People	Jeremiah 33:16 • 1 Corinthians 1:30 • Romans 3:22
A Priesthood That Does Not Pass Away	Jeremiah 33:18 • Hebrews 7:23-25 • 1 Peter 2:5
He Has Not Cast Off His People	Jeremiah 33:26 • Romans 11:1-2 • Luke 1:54-55

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 33 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the call-to-me promise, the restoration oracles, and the Branch prophecy repeated
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 33](#) - the perpetual Davidic and Levitical promises and how they are understood covenantally
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 33](#) - exposition of verse 3 in its actual setting and the transfer of the name in verse 16

Jeremiah 33 - Opening Intro

Verse 3 has been embroidered onto more wall hangings than almost any sentence in Jeremiah, and like 29:11 it is usually lifted clean out of its address. So look at where the man receiving it is standing.

He is locked up. The siege ramps are finished. The houses of Jerusalem are being demolished for rubble to plug the holes in the wall, and verse 5 says plainly that it will not work. That is the room in which God says: call to me, and I will answer you, and will show you great and difficult things which you don't know.

The Hebrew word behind "difficult" carries the sense of fortified, inaccessible - things walled off from you. It is an invitation to ask about what you cannot get to on your own. And it is offered to a prisoner, which should tell us something about where God does some of His best talking.

Then watch this chapter systematically undo the book. Chapter 30 said the wound was incurable; verse 6 says health and cure. Chapters 7 and 25 said the voice of the bridegroom and the bride would cease; verse 11 puts it back, along with the thanksgiving refrain the returning exiles would actually sing when the foundation was relaid. The demolition list is being read backward.

And there is a detail in verse 16 that is easy to miss. In chapter 23 the Branch is given the name Yahweh Tsidkenu - Yahweh Our Righteousness. Here the identical name is given to Jerusalem. What belongs to Him is put on her. If you have ever wondered where the New Testament gets the idea of an imputed righteousness, a name transferred from the King to the city He saves, it is sitting right here in a prophecy delivered from a prison.

Before we read, notice how the chapter answers despair. The people are asking whether God has finally cast off the two families He chose. He does not argue. He points out the window and says: if you can cancel tomorrow morning, then you can cancel this.

Jeremiah 33:1-26 (WEB)

1 Moreover Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah the second time, while he was still locked up in the court of the guard, saying,

2 "Yahweh who does it, Yahweh who forms it to establish it—Yahweh is his name, says:

3 'Call to me, and I will answer you, and will show you great and difficult things, which you don't know.'^{25,26}

4 For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says concerning the houses of this city and concerning the houses of the kings of Judah, which are broken down to make a defense against the mounds and against the sword;

5 while men come to fight with the Chaldeans, and to fill them with the dead bodies of men, whom I have killed in my anger and in my wrath, and for all whose wickedness I have hidden my face from this city:

6 'Behold, I will bring it health and cure, and I will cure them; and I will reveal to them abundance of peace and truth.'²⁷

7 I will cause the captivity of Judah and the captivity of Israel to return, and will build them, as at the first.

²⁵ Cross-Reference: [Psalm 91:15](#) • [Isaiah 65:24](#) - he will call on me and I will answer him - and answered before they finish calling

²⁶ Messianic Connection: [John 15:7](#) • [Ephesians 3:20](#) - ask whatever you desire, from the One able to do far beyond all we ask or think

²⁷ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 30:17](#) • [Isaiah 57:18-19](#) - the incurable wound of the previous scroll answered - I will heal him, and restore comfort

8 I will cleanse them from all their iniquity by which they have sinned against me. I will pardon all their iniquities by which they have sinned against me and by which they have transgressed against me.

9 This city will be to me for a name of joy, for praise, and for glory, before all the nations of the earth, which will hear all the good that I do to them, and will fear and tremble for all the good and for all the peace that I provide to it.”

10 Yahweh says: “Yet again there will be heard in this place, about which you say, ‘It is waste, without man and without animal, even in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, that are desolate, without man and without inhabitant and without animal,’

11 the voice of joy and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the voice of those who say, ‘Give thanks to Yahweh of Armies, for Yahweh is good, for his loving kindness endures forever;’ who bring thanksgiving into Yahweh’s house. For I will cause the captivity of the land to be reversed as at the first,” says Yahweh.^{28,29}

12 Yahweh of Armies says: “Yet again there will be in this place, which is waste, without man and without animal, and in all its cities, a habitation of shepherds causing their flocks to lie down.

13 In the cities of the hill country, in the cities of the lowland, in the cities of the South, in the land of Benjamin, in the places around Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, the flocks will again pass under the hands of him who counts them,” says Yahweh.

14 “Behold, the days come,” says Yahweh, “that I will perform that good word which I have spoken concerning the house of Israel and concerning the house of Judah.

15 “In those days and at that time, I will cause a Branch of righteousness to grow up to David. He will execute justice and righteousness in the land.”³⁰

16 In those days Judah will be saved, and Jerusalem will dwell safely. This is the name by which she will be called: Yahweh our righteousness.”³¹

17 For Yahweh says: “David will never lack a man to sit on the throne of the house of Israel.”³²

18 The priests the Levites won’t lack a man before me to offer burnt offerings, to burn meal offerings, and to do sacrifice continually.”^{33,34}

19 Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah, saying,

²⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Psalm 136:1](#) • [2 Chronicles 5:13](#) - the refrain sung at the temple’s dedication, and again when its foundation was relaid

²⁹ **Messianic Connection:** [John 3:29](#) • [Revelation 19:7](#) - the friend of the bridegroom rejoicing at his voice, and the marriage of the Lamb

³⁰ **Messianic Connection:** [Jeremiah 23:5-6](#) • [Isaiah 4:2](#) - the Branch oracle repeated, and the Branch of Yahweh beautiful and glorious in that day

³¹ **Messianic Connection:** [1 Corinthians 1:30](#) • [Romans 3:22](#) - the King’s own name put upon His city - righteousness from God given through faith

³² **Cross-Reference:** [2 Samuel 7:12-16](#) • [Psalm 89:3-4](#) - the oath sworn to David that his throne would be established forever

20 “Yahweh says: ‘If you can break my covenant of the day and my covenant of the night, so that there will not be day and night in their time;’³⁵

21 then may my covenant also be broken with David my servant, that he won’t have a son to reign on his throne; and with the Levites the priests, my ministers.

22 As the army of the sky can’t be counted, and the sand of the sea can’t be measured; so I will multiply the offspring of David my servant and the Levites who minister to me.”

23 Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah, saying,

24 “Don’t consider what this people has spoken, saying, ‘Has Yahweh cast off the two families which he chose?’ Thus they despise my people, that they should be no more a nation before them.”

25 Yahweh says: “If my covenant of day and night fails, if I have not appointed the ordinances of heaven and earth;

26 then I will also cast away the offspring of Jacob, and of David my servant, so that I will not take of his offspring to be rulers over the offspring of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: for I will cause their captivity to be reversed and will have mercy on them.”³⁶

³³ **Cross-Reference:** [Numbers 25:12-13](#) • [Malachi 3:3](#) - a covenant of everlasting priesthood, and sons of Levi purified to offer in righteousness

³⁴ **Messianic Connection:** [Hebrews 7:23-25](#) • [1 Peter 2:5](#) - a priesthood that does not pass away, and a holy priesthood built of living stones

³⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Genesis 8:22](#) • [Psalm 89:36-37](#) - seedtime and harvest not ceasing, a throne established as the sun and the faithful witness in the sky

³⁶ **Messianic Connection:** [Romans 11:1-2](#) • [Luke 1:54-55](#) - God has not rejected His people whom He foreknew - mercy remembered toward Abraham forever

Major Themes Across Jeremiah 31-33

- Love that precedes the drawing - everlasting first, and the turning as its consequence
- Repentance asked for as a gift: "Turn me, and I will be turned"
- A God whose insides churn over His people, described in the language of a parent rather than a judge
- Inherited fate retired - each person answering for his own iniquity, and the sour-grapes excuse withdrawn
- A new covenant whose newness is location rather than content: the same Torah, moved from stone to heart
- Sin forgiven and deliberately not remembered, as the ground of the whole arrangement
- Obedience before understanding - a field bought at full price in a city about to fall
- Honest prayer that begins in confidence and ends in confusion, and is answered rather than rebuked
- God's own question handed back to us: is there anything too hard for me?
- Promises anchored to sunrise and sea, so that the covenant fails only if creation does
- The demolition list read backward - silenced joy restored, an incurable wound healed, Hinnom made holy

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May the God who loved us with an everlasting love before we ever turned toward Him settle that order in us for good, so that we stop trying to earn what has already been given.

May He turn us where we cannot turn ourselves, and may we have the honesty of Ephraim to ask for it rather than pretend we managed it.

May He write His Torah on our inward parts until obedience stops feeling like a foreign language, and may we know Him ourselves and not only by report.

May He forgive our iniquity and remember our sin no more, and may we stop remembering what He has chosen to forget.

May we obey before we understand, buying the field when the siege ramps are up, and may He receive our confused prayers afterward without rebuke.

May we answer His question honestly - is anything too hard for Him - and live as though we believed our own confession.

And may He take the valley of dead bodies and ashes in each of our histories and make it holy to Yahweh, never to be plucked up or thrown down again.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.